

Evgeniia Mitrokhina

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EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin–Madison

Ph.D., Political Science expected 2027

Fields: Comparative Politics, Quantitative Methods, International Relations (minor)

M.A., Political Science 2022

National Research University Higher School of Economics, Moscow

M.A., Sociology (with honors) 2017

B.A., Political Science 2015

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Authoritarian politics; information control; transparency; courts and the rule of law; bureaucracy and state–society relations; political economy; causal inference; Russia.

DISSERTATION

Transparency Defanged: How Autocrats Enforce Freedom of Information.

Why do authoritarian states adopt and actively administer access to information (FOI) laws, institutions that appear to empower citizens against the state? I argue that these laws function as instruments of directional control, channeling information downward to citizens, upward to the center, and horizontally across agencies, rather than as channels of bottom-up accountability. I test this with original data from Russia, combining a census of roughly 30,000 court decisions citing the federal FOI statute with difference-in-differences and event-study designs around regional and federal transparency mandates and an original survey experiment on citizen demand. The central result is that authoritarian actors institutionalize a controlled form of transparency—openness that signals accountability while leaving informational power intact.

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

- Rochlitz, M., **Mitrokhina, E.**, & Nizovkina, I. (2021). “Bureaucratic Discrimination in Electoral Authoritarian Regimes: Experimental Evidence from Russia.” *European Journal of Political Economy*, 66, 101957.
- Chmel, K., Mavletova, A., & **Mitrokhina, E.** (2020). “Politicization of Environmental Discourse in Arkhangelsk Region: The Case of Construction at Shies Railroad Station.” *Journal of Social Policy Studies*, (1), 83–98. (in Russian)

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- Hendley, K., **Mitrokhina, E.**, & Molina, E. F. (2026). “The Impact of COVID-19 on Who Goes to Court.” *Willamette Journal of International Law and Dispute Resolution*, 33(2), 250–285. (law review article)
- Herrera, Y. M., & **Mitrokhina, E.** (2024). “Russia’s Informal Economy.” In H. E. Hale, J. Johnson, & T. V. Lankina (Eds.), *Developments in Russian Politics 10* (pp. 127–142). Duke University Press. (book chapter)

WORKING PAPERS

- “Transparency under Constraint: The Adoption of Access-to-Information Laws in Autocracies.” (under review)
- “Transparency as Control: Freedom-of-Information Litigation in Authoritarian Russia.”
- “Constraining the Public Record: Investigative Media and Administrative Transparency in Authoritarian Russia.” (with Malika Talgatova)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- **Research Assistant**, University of Wisconsin–Madison (Prof. Kathryn Hendley) 2021–present
- **Research Associate**, Nonviolent Repression in Electoral Autocracies (Katerina Tertytchnaya) 2024–2025
- **Research Assistant**, Laboratory for Comparative Social Research, HSE 2017–2020
- **Visiting Scholar**, Center for Russia, East Europe, and Central Asia, UW–Madison 2019–2020
- **Visiting Scholar**, Harriman Institute, Columbia University 2019

PRESENTATIONS

APPAM (2026); American Political Science Association (2026); Midwest Political Science Association (2025, 2026); ASEEES Annual Convention (2024, 2025); “Engaging Democratic and Authoritarian Politics,” All Souls College, University of Oxford (2025); Junior Law and Politics Research Community (2025); Comparative Politics Colloquium, UW–Madison (2025); Building Institutional Resilience, University of Chicago Malvi Center (2024); New Advances in the Political Economy of Development in Eurasia, Almaty (2024); Graduate Workshop in Contentious and Non-Democratic Politics, University of Oxford (2024).

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Experimental Research: Design, Analysis, and Interpretation (Donald P. Green, Columbia University, 2019); Survey Experiments (Thomas Leeper, Barcelona Summer School in Survey Methodology, 2018); Panel Data Analysis (ECPR Summer School, CEU Budapest, 2017).

GRANTS AND AWARDS

- Scott A. Harris Graduate Summer Writing Scholarship, UW–Madison 2026
- Ronald Rapoport Summer Research Collaborative Program, Rapoport Family Foundation 2025
- Student Research Grants Competition, UW–Madison 2025
- Experimental Politics Workshop Grant, UW–Madison 2024
- Carnegie/Harriman Research Grant for Ph.D. Students in the Social Sciences 2023
- Summer Initiative Grant, UW–Madison 2022, 2024–26
- University Fellowship, UW–Madison 2020–21, 2025–26

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Wisconsin–Madison

- Grader, Introduction to Comparative Politics Spring 2026
- Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Comparative Politics Fall 2022

Higher School of Economics

- Instructor, Comparative Politics Spring 2020
- Instructor, Research Methods in Communication Studies Spring 2019, 2020
- Instructor, Introduction to R Programming Fall 2016–2018

- Teaching Assistant, Basic Statistics

Fall 2016–2018

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Programming and Software: R, Stata, SPSS, Qualtrics, L^AT_EX.

Languages: Russian (native); English (fluent).

REFERENCES

Available upon request.